ravines of the mountain sides with many and swiftly following curves, and soon the first of the devices for easing the gradient is passed (Loop 1). [83]

Continuing the upward journey, fine views are soon obtained over the lower hills. A great wooded mountain, Selim Hill (3,500 feet), looms up in front. The train passes under a bridge, circles round the end of the spur and then crosses the bridge (Loop 2). The spot is well known locally as the haunt of the leopard, and it is said that over a hundred have been killed here during a space of twenty years. [84]

Today, many such anecdotes are difficult to imagine and seem out of place, but such stories keep the railway romance alive, taking us back on a nostalgic trail—or rather a track, I should say.

A HAUNTED RAIL TUNNEL

And now here's a spooky tale of a suicidal engineer, his ghost and a sadhu with possible divine powers who guided British engineers to build a rail tunnel, still remembered in his name.

In short, the narrative is about a British railway engineer who committed suicide due to humiliation after he miscalculated the alignment while building a tunnel on the KSR. Deeply hurt after he was fined ₹1 by the British government and unable to face the workers he had made toil for the tunnel, Colonel Barog killed himself with his own gun during a morning walk. The tunnel was later completed with the help of a local saint, who has been acknowledged and applauded in the government records.

For starters, the KSR is a 2-foot-6-inch (762 mm) narrow gauge line documented as UNESCO-listed heritage among the Mountain Railways of India. Opened on Monday, 9 November 1903, the line included 889 long and short bridges and 107 tunnels. All the tunnels were re-numbered in the 1930s, and four that were found unfit for operation were later closed. Thus only 103 tunnels were in operation after 1930. After seventy-six years, in 2006, Tunnel No. 46 near the Solan Brewery was also dismantled, leaving 102 tunnels in operation.

All this tunnel talk is to link the narrative with the mysterious Tunnel 33, or the Barog Tunnel.

The tunnel at Barog (at a distance of about 42 km from Kalka) is 1.14 km long and is the longest tunnel on the KSR section. Trains running at 25 kmph took about 25 minutes to cross it, and Barog station immediately follows it. Barog is a small railway town named after Colonel Barog. When